

PHASE 5

CREATING A NEW SERVICE PORTAL

Giving employees a clean, focused, branded home for raising and tracking issues.

Employee Raise Issue — ServiceNow Implementation Guide
Standalone Phase Document 5 of 7

Document Version 1.0

About This Document

This document is a standalone, self-contained implementation guide for Phase 5 — Creating a New Service Portal — of the Employee Raise Issue project. It can be read and actioned on its own, without needing the full multi-phase master documentation, though it references the wider project for context where useful.

Field	Detail
Application	Employee Raise Issue (built within the Employee Center scope)
Phase	Phase 5 of 7
Primary Owner	Service Portal / Front-End Developer
Related Document	Employee Raise Issue Documentation (full 7-phase project reference)
Instance Referenced	dev218486.service-now.com
Document Version	1.0

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1. Purpose and Scope

This document is the complete, standalone implementation guide for Phase 5 of the Employee Raise Issue project: standing up the Service Portal that hosts the Record Producer built in Phase 4, and giving employees a dedicated place to raise and later track issues.

By the end of this phase, a portal is live at a memorable URL, with a home page, a page hosting the Record Producer, a confirmation page, and (optionally) a page listing an employee's own past issues.

2. Where This Phase Fits in the Project

- Depends on: the Record Producer from Phase 4, which this portal embeds and links to.
- Feeds into: Phase 6, which builds and places the custom widgets used on these pages.
- Verified by: Phase 7's functional tests (TC-06, TC-07) and the live-URL check in this phase's own screenshots.

Relationship	Detail
Upstream dependency	Phase 4's Record Producer must already be active before the Raise an Issue page can be built against it.
Downstream dependency	Phase 6's widgets are placed onto the pages created in this phase; building this phase incompletely blocks Phase 6 from starting cleanly.
Shared ownership	Portal-level decisions here (theme, menu, branding) affect every future page added to this application, not just the four built in this phase.

3. Objective

Give employees a clean, focused destination for raising and tracking issues, independent of (or, where appropriate, built as new pages within) any general-purpose employee self-service portal already in use.

4. Prerequisites

- Phase 4 complete: a working, active Record Producer exists.
- A decision on whether to build a brand-new portal or add pages to an existing one (see the note in section 5).
- A short, memorable URL suffix agreed with stakeholders, since this becomes part of the link shared with every employee.
- Branding assets (logo, color palette) if a new theme is required.

5. Step-by-Step Configuration

1. Navigate to Service Portal > Portals, or use the Service Portal Designer / Configuration application.
2. Select New to create a portal record, or Duplicate an existing portal as a starting template if one with a suitable theme and menu structure already exists.
3. Set Title to a clear, employee-facing name, for example Requesting Portal.
4. Set the URL suffix — short and memorable, for example employee_request.
5. Set the Homepage to a suitable landing page. If reusing an existing portal's homepage (as in the working build), confirm it makes sense as the entry point for this use case, or create a dedicated one.

6. Assign a Theme, choosing or cloning one so header, footer, and color palette are consistent with corporate branding.
7. Confirm Public is set appropriately — false for an internal, authenticated-only experience — and configure the Login page accordingly.
8. Assign a Main menu that includes links relevant to this use case.
9. Save the portal record and confirm it resolves at the expected URL.

Figure 7 — Requesting portal configuration: URL suffix `employee_request`, built on the `ec_standard_home` homepage, `Employee Center` Menu, and `Employee Center Coral Theme`.

6. Screenshot Reference

Figure 7 shows the portal's core configuration screen. Figure 8 below confirms the portal resolves correctly in a browser once published — always verify this directly rather than assuming the configuration alone guarantees a working URL.

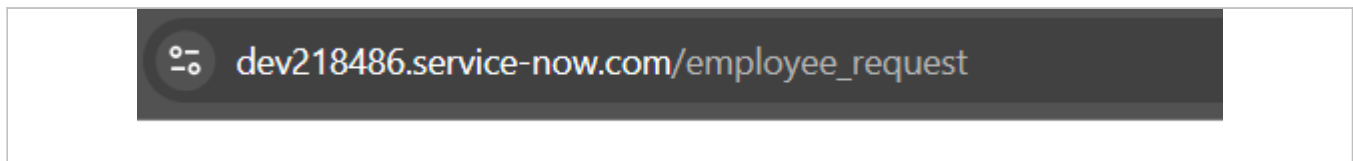


Figure 8 — Live portal address bar confirming the `Requesting` portal resolves at `dev218486.service-now.com/employee_request`.

NOTE: The portal was named `Requesting Portal` (URL suffix `employee_request`) in the working build, built on top of the existing `ec_standard_home` homepage, `Employee Center Menu`, and `Employee Center Coral Theme` rather than entirely new artifacts. Reusing an existing, well-established theme and menu structure is often faster and more consistent than building every portal element from scratch — see section 14.

7. Pages Created

Page	Route Suffix	Purpose
Employee Issue Home	employee-issue-home	Landing page introducing the service, with a call-to-action leading to the Raise an Issue page.
Raise an Issue	raise-issue	Hosts the Record Producer widget so employees can complete and submit the intake form.

Page	Route Suffix	Purpose
My Issues	my-issues	Lists issues previously submitted by the logged-in employee, with status (built out fully in Phase 6).
Issue Confirmation	issue-confirmation	Displayed after successful submission, showing the generated issue number.

8. Page Layout

Each page uses the Service Portal's row/column layout, built from the standard grid used by the Portal Designer:

- A full-width Header row containing a page banner widget with the page title and a short description.
- A centered, single-column content row housing the primary widget for that page (for example, the Record Producer widget on Raise an Issue, or the My Issues List widget from Phase 6 on My Issues).
- A footer row reusing the portal's standard footer widget for consistency with the rest of the instance.

9. Navigation and Menu

1. Configure the portal's Menu (via the header/footer widget instance options) to include links to Home, Raise an Issue, and My Issues.
2. Restrict the My Issues link so it is only visible to authenticated, non-guest users using the widget instance's Roles condition.
3. Add a breadcrumb widget to the Raise an Issue and My Issues pages so employees can navigate back to Home easily.

10. Branding and Accessibility

- Apply the corporate color palette to the theme's CSS variables (header background, accent color, link color).
- Verify color contrast ratios meet WCAG AA guidance for body text and buttons.
- Confirm all interactive elements are reachable via keyboard navigation and carry appropriate aria-label attributes.

10.1 Accessibility Checklist

Item	Target
Text color contrast against background	WCAG AA minimum (4.5:1 for body text)
Buttons and links reachable by keyboard (Tab order)	All interactive elements reachable, visible focus state
Form fields have associated labels	Every Record Producer variable has a readable label, not placeholder-only text
Images have alt text	Logo and any decorative images carry appropriate alt attributes
Page usable at 200% browser zoom	No content clipped or overlapping

NOTE: Building a dedicated portal is appropriate when the employee-facing experience needs to be visually and navigationally distinct from existing self-service portals. Where an Employee Center-style portal already exists, adding new pages to that portal (as in this build) is usually preferable to standing up a fully parallel one.

11. Deployment Considerations

Portal configuration is packaged as part of the application scope, alongside the table and Record Producer from earlier phases, so it moves through Update Sets or source control the same way. A few portal-specific points are worth planning for ahead of go-live:

- Test the portal URL from outside the platform's own navigator — bookmarks, email links, and QR codes on posters all rely on the exact URL suffix chosen in section 5.
- Confirm the portal's Login page redirects correctly for a user who is not yet authenticated, rather than showing a broken or generic error page.
- If promoting to a Test or Production instance with a different base URL, update any hardcoded links shared with employees (posters, onboarding documents, intranet pages) to match.

11.1 Promotion Steps for the Portal

1. Complete and unit-test all portal pages in the Development instance, as documented in sections 5–10.
2. Capture the portal record, its pages, and any theme changes in an Update Set (or commit to source control, if configured).
3. Promote to the Test instance and re-verify the live URL check from section 6 (Figure 8) against the Test instance's own base URL.
4. Re-run the functional checks in section 13 on the Test instance before requesting sign-off.
5. Schedule the Production release alongside the rest of the application (table, Record Producer, widgets) so employees see a complete, working experience from day one rather than a partially available portal.

11.2 Rollback Plan

Because the portal, its pages, and its theme changes are scoped to this application, rolling back is as simple as deactivating the portal record. Employees attempting to reach its URL after rollback should be redirected to a clear fallback (for example, the existing general self-service portal or a simple maintenance notice) rather than a bare 404 page.

12. Common Issues and Troubleshooting

Issue	Likely Cause	Resolution
Portal URL returns a 404	URL suffix mismatch, or the portal record is inactive.	Double-check the exact URL suffix configured in section 5, and confirm the portal is active.
Employee is stuck on a login loop	The Login page configured on the portal does not match the instance's authentication setup.	Review the Login page setting and the instance's authentication configuration together with a platform administrator.
Theme colors do not match corporate branding	A shared theme is being used and edited theme changes affect other portals too.	Clone the theme before editing so changes are isolated to this portal.
My Issues link is visible to guest users	The menu item's Roles condition was left blank.	Restrict the link to an authenticated role.
Page looks correct on desktop but broken on mobile	A widget or custom CSS uses fixed pixel widths instead of responsive units.	Review widget CSS for fixed widths; prefer relative units and the portal's built-in responsive grid classes.

12.1 Support and Ownership for This Portal

Once live, the portal needs a clear, named owner distinct from whoever owns the underlying Employee Issue table or Record Producer, since portal issues (broken links, theme problems, page layout regressions) are often reported separately from data or routing problems.

Area	Owner
Portal pages, theme, and menu	Service Portal / Front-End Developer
Record Producer content hosted on the portal	Service Catalog Administrator (Phase 4)
Underlying table and routing logic	Platform Administrator (Phases 2–3)
Day-to-day "the portal looks broken" reports	General IT Service Desk, escalating to the Front-End Developer if not a simple fix

13. Validating Phase 5 Completion

Check	Expected Result
Portal resolves at its intended URL for an authenticated employee	Loads without errors
All four pages from section 7 are reachable via navigation	Each page loads and matches its intended purpose
Raise an Issue page displays and accepts submissions	A submission via the Phase 4 Record Producer succeeds end to end
Unauthenticated access is blocked	User is redirected to login rather than seeing portal content
Mobile rendering	Portal renders correctly on at least one mobile device or emulated mobile viewport

14. Best Practices

BEST PRACTICE: Reuse an existing, well-maintained portal theme and menu structure wherever the audience and branding genuinely overlap — building a parallel portal from scratch multiplies the surface area to maintain for very little employee-facing benefit.

BEST PRACTICE: Choose the URL suffix with the same care as a public-facing domain name — it will end up on posters, in onboarding emails, and in employees' bookmarks.

BEST PRACTICE: Keep page layouts intentionally simple (one primary widget per page) rather than replicating a dashboard-style layout; a focused intake and status experience outperforms a busy one for this kind of self-service tool.

14.1 Frequently Asked Questions

Do we need a brand-new portal for every new employee-facing idea?

No. As with the application scope decision in Phase 1, extending an existing, well-suited portal (as this project did with an Employee Center-based portal) is often the right call, reserving a new portal for genuinely distinct audiences or branding needs.

Can the same page be reused across more than one portal?

Pages are portal-specific in the Service Portal model, though the widgets placed on them (built in Phase 6) can be reused freely across multiple pages and portals — design widgets with that reuse in mind.

What is the fastest way to test portal changes without affecting real employees?

Use a personal Update Set or a non-production instance, and test as a dedicated non-admin test user, not as an administrator — administrators often have broader visibility that can mask ACL or role-based issues real employees would encounter.

14.2 Launch Communication for This Portal

A portal is only useful if employees know it exists. Before announcing go-live more broadly, plan a short communication introducing the new portal, and consider a brief overlap period where the previous email-based or informal channel remains available, so no issue is lost while employees adjust to the new destination.

- Send a short announcement with a direct link to the portal's home page, not just its base URL.
- Brief HR and IT Support agents on the new portal's existence before the wider announcement, so they can redirect anyone who emails or calls them directly instead.
- Keep the previous channel monitored for a short transition period, logging anything received there manually until portal adoption stabilizes.

15. Summary and Handoff to Phase 6

At the end of this phase, employees have a live, branded, navigable portal with a working Raise an Issue page and confirmation flow. The remaining pages — particularly My Issues — are ready to be completed with the custom widgets built in Phase 6 — Creating Widgets and Adding to the Page.

15.1 Widget Placeholders Awaiting Phase 6

Page	Widget Still Needed	What It Will Do
Employee Issue Home	Landing banner widget	Present a welcoming call-to-action leading to Raise an Issue
My Issues	My Issues list widget	Query the Employee Issue table for the logged-in employee and display status
Raise an Issue	None — already hosts the Phase 4 Record Producer widget natively	N/A

15.2 Phase 5 Deliverables Checklist

Deliverable	Status
Portal created and live at its intended URL	Complete
Employee Issue Home, Raise an Issue, My Issues, and Confirmation pages created	Complete
Menu and navigation configured with appropriate role restrictions	Complete
Branding and accessibility reviewed	Complete

Deliverable	Status
Raise an Issue page successfully hosts the Phase 4 Record Producer	Complete
Ready for Phase 6 widget development	Ready